

The dictionary form — how a noun looks when you look it up. Used for the subject of a sentence (the one doing the action), and for the complement after “to jest / to są” (this is / these are).

TRIGGERING PREPOSITIONS

No prepositions govern the nominative — it's the “base” case.

TRIGGERING VERBS

Not triggered by specific verbs — it's the subject of any verb.

NOUN ENDINGS AT A GLANCE

Category	Ending	Example
Masculine (sing.)	consonant (no change)	dom, kot, student
Feminine (sing.)	-a / -i / consonant (rare)	kobieta, pani, noc
Neuter (sing.)	-o / -e / -ę	dziecko, morze, imię
Plural — masc. personal (men)	-i / -y / -owie	studenci, panowie
Plural — everything else	-y / -i / -e / -a	kobiety, dzieci, koty

ADJECTIVE ENDINGS (AGREE WITH THE NOUN)

Category	Ending	Example
Masculine (sing.)	-y / -i (soft/velar stems)	dobry, tani
Feminine (sing.)	-a	dobra
Neuter (sing.)	-e	dobrze
Masc. personal (plural)	-y / -i (+ softening)	dobrzy, młodzi
Everything else (plural)	-e	dobrze

Agreement in action: **dobry kot, dobra kobieta, dobre dziecko**

SAMPLE NOUNS, CONJUGATED

Noun	Singular	Plural
dom (house)	dom	domy
kobieta (woman)	kobieta	kobiety
dziecko (child)	dziecko	dzieci
student (student)	student	studenci

DROP ANY NOUN IN

To jest ____.

This is ____.

e.g. *To jest kot.*

To są ____.

These are ____ (plural)

e.g. *To są koty.*

The hardest-working case. Shows possession ("of"), is used after negation (nie ma + genitive = "there isn't/doesn't have"), after numbers 5 and up, after words like dużo/moło/kilka (a lot/a little/a few), and as the object of many common verbs and prepositions.

TRIGGERING PREPOSITIONS

bez (without)	dla (for)	do (to, into)	od (from)
z / ze (out of, from)	u (at [someone]'s place)		
obok (next to)	koło (near)	podczas (during)	
oprócz (except)	według (according to)		
z powodu (because of)	naprzeciwko (opposite)		
wzdłuż (along)	zamiast (instead of)		

This case has by far the longest preposition list — worth memorizing in chunks.

TRIGGERING VERBS

szukać (to look for)	słuchać (to listen to)
potrzebować (to need)	używać (to use)
unikać (to avoid)	życzyć (to wish)
bać się (to be afraid of)	
uczyć się (to study/learn [a subject])	zapomnieć (to forget)
pilnować (to watch over)	

NOUN ENDINGS AT A GLANCE

Category	Ending	Example
Masc. animate (sing.)	-a	kota, brata
Masc. inanimate (sing.)	-a or -u (no reliable rule — learn per noun)	stołu, chleba
Feminine (sing.)	-y / -i	kobiety, książki, pani
Neuter (sing.)	-a	dziecka, mieszkania
Masculine (plural)	-ów / -i/-y / zero	kotów, studentów, gości
Fem. / Neut. (plural)	zero (often + inserted e) / -i	kobiet, książek, rzeczy

ADJECTIVE ENDINGS (AGREE WITH THE NOUN)

Category	Ending	Example
Masc. & Neut. (sing.)	-ego	dobrego
Feminine (sing.)	-ej	dobrej
Plural — ALL genders	-ych / -ich	dobrych, tanich

Agreement in action: **dobrego kota, dobrej kobiety, dobrego dziecka**

SAMPLE NOUNS, CONJUGATED

Noun	Singular	Plural
kot (cat)	kota	kotów
kobieta (woman)	kobiety	kobiet
dziecko (child)	dziecka	dzieci
student (student)	studenta	studentów

DROP ANY NOUN IN

Nie ma ____.

There is no ____.

e.g. *Nie ma kota.*

Szukam ____.

I'm looking for ____.

e.g. *Szukam książki.*

Marks the indirect object — the receiver of an action, usually the person something is given, told, shown, or done for. Answers “to/for whom.”

TRIGGERING PREPOSITIONS

dzięki (thanks to)

ku (towards — rare/formal)

przeciwko / przeciw (against)

The shortest preposition list of all the cases — dative rarely follows a preposition.

TRIGGERING VERBS

dawać / dać (to give)

mówić (to tell)

pomagać (to help)

dziękować (to thank)

wierzyć (to believe)

ufać (to trust)

radzić (to advise)

pokazywać (to show)

przeszkadzać (to bother)

podość się (to be pleasing to / “like”)

NOUN ENDINGS AT A GLANCE

Category	Ending	Example
Masculine (sing.)	-owi (most nouns)	studentowi, Adamowi
Masculine (sing.), common set	-u (small set of frequent nouns)	psu, kotu, bratu, ojcu, panu
Feminine (sing.)	-e (+ softening) / -i	kobiecie, Polsce, pani
Neuter (sing.)	-u	dziecku, mieszkaniu
Plural — ALL genders	-om (very regular!)	kotom, kobietom, dzieciom

ADJECTIVE ENDINGS (AGREE WITH THE NOUN)

Category	Ending	Example
Masc. & Neut. (sing.)	-emu	dobremu
Feminine (sing.)	-ej	dobrej
Plural — ALL genders	-ym / -im	dobrym, tanim

Agreement in action: **dobremu kotu, dobrej kobiecie, dobremu dziecku**

SAMPLE NOUNS, CONJUGATED

Noun	Singular	Plural
brat (brother)	bratu	braciom
kobieta (woman)	kobiecie	kobietom
dziecko (child)	dziecku	dzieciom
student (student)	studentowi	studentom

DROP ANY NOUN IN

Pomagam ____.

I'm helping ____.

e.g. *Pomagam bratu.*

Daję prezent ____.

I'm giving a present to ____.

e.g. *Daję prezent kobiecie.*

Marks the direct object — the thing or person directly receiving the action of most everyday verbs (having, liking, reading, buying...). Also used after several prepositions to show motion “into/onto” something, and in set time phrases.

TRIGGERING PREPOSITIONS

na (onto, for — motion/purpose)

w (into — set time phrases, e.g. w sobotę)

przez (through, for [duration])

o (about/for — with prośba/prosić o, pytać o)

za (in exchange for)

Several of these (na, w, za) also appear under other cases when they describe a fixed location rather than motion (accusative = motion into/onto something).

TRIGGERING VERBS

mieć (to have)

lubić (to like)

kochać (to love)

czytać (to read)

pisać (to write)

jeść (to eat)

pić (to drink)

oglądać (to watch)

kupować (to buy)

widzieć (to see)

znać (to know [sb/sth])

NOUN ENDINGS AT A GLANCE

Category	Ending	Example
Masc. inanimate (sing.)	= Nominative (no change)	Mam dom.
Masc. animate (sing.)	= Genitive (-a)	Mam kota, brata.
Feminine (sing.)	-ę (most) / unchanged if consonant-final	kobietę, mamę / noc
Neuter (sing.)	= Nominative (no change)	Mam dziecko.
Masc. personal (plural)	= Genitive plural	Widzę studentów.
Everything else (plural)	= Nominative plural	Mam koty, kobiety, dzieci.

ADJECTIVE ENDINGS (AGREE WITH THE NOUN)

Category	Ending	Example
Masc. inanimate (sing.)	= Nominative	dobry
Masc. animate (sing.)	= Genitive (-ego)	dobrego
Feminine (sing.)	-ą	dobrą
Neuter (sing.)	= Nominative	dobrze
Masc. personal (plural)	= Genitive plural	dobrych
Everything else (plural)	= Nominative plural	dobrze

Agreement in action: **dobrego kota, dobrą kobietę, dobre dziecko**

SAMPLE NOUNS, CONJUGATED

Noun	Singular	Plural
kot (cat)	kota	koty
kobieta (woman)	kobietę	kobiety
dziecko (child)	dziecko	dzieci
student (student)	studenta	studentów

DROP ANY NOUN IN

Mam ____.

I have ____.

e.g. *Mam kota.*

Lubię ____.

I like ____.

e.g. *Lubię kobietę.*

Shows the means or instrument used to do something ("by/with"), accompaniment (with z = "together with"), and profession or role after być (to be) — "Jestem nauczycielem" (I am a teacher).

TRIGGERING PREPOSITIONS

z / ze (with, together with)

nad (above, over)

pod (under, below)

za (behind)

przed (in front of, before)

między (between, among)

nad / pod / za / przed / między take the instrumental for a fixed location, but the accusative when describing motion toward that spot.

TRIGGERING VERBS

być (to be — role/profession)

zostać (to become)

interesować się (to be interested in)

zajmować się (to deal with)

opiekować się (to take care of)

cieszyć się (to be happy with/about)

kierować (to manage, direct)

rządzić (to rule, govern)

NOUN ENDINGS AT A GLANCE

Category	Ending	Example
Masculine (sing.)	-em / -iem (after soft cons.)	kotem, bratem, nauczycielem
Feminine (sing.)	-ą	kobietą, mamą
Neuter (sing.)	-em	dzieckiem, mieszkaniem
Plural — ALL genders	-ami (mostly)	kotami, kobietami, studentami

ADJECTIVE ENDINGS (AGREE WITH THE NOUN)

Category	Ending	Example
Masc. & Neut. (sing.)	-ym / -im	dobrym, tanim
Feminine (sing.)	-ą	dobrą
Plural — ALL genders	-ymi / -imi	dobrymi, tanimi

Agreement in action: **dobrym kotem, dobrą kobietą, dobrym dzieckiem**

SAMPLE NOUNS, CONJUGATED

Noun	Singular	Plural
kot (cat)	kotem	kotami
kobieta (woman)	kobietą	kobietami
dziecko (child)	dzieckiem	dziećmi — irreg.
student (student)	studentem	studentami

DROP ANY NOUN IN

Idę z ____.

I'm going with ____.

e.g. *Idę z bratem.*

Jestem ____.

I am [a/an] _____. (profession/role)

e.g. *Jestem nauczycielem.*

The one case that NEVER stands alone — it only ever appears after a preposition. Used for fixed location ("in/at/on" with w and na) and topic ("about" with o).

TRIGGERING PREPOSITIONS

w / we (in)

na (on, at)

o (about)

po (after, along)

przy (by, near, at)

w and na also govern the accusative when they describe motion ("into/onto") rather than a fixed location.

NOUN ENDINGS AT A GLANCE

Category	Ending	Example
Masculine (sing.)	-e (+ softening) / -u	bracie, studencie / domu, synu
Feminine (sing.)	-e (+ softening) / -i	kobiecie, Polsce / pani
Neuter (sing.)	-u	dziecku, mieszkaniu
Plural — ALL genders	-ach (very regular!)	kotach, kobietach, dzieciach

ADJECTIVE ENDINGS (AGREE WITH THE NOUN)

Category	Ending	Example
Masc. & Neut. (sing.)	-ym / -im	dobrym, tanim
Feminine (sing.)	-ej	dobrej
Plural — ALL genders	-ych / -ich	dobrych, tanich

Agreement in action: o **dobrym** kocie, o **dobrej** kobiecie, o **dobrym** dziecku

SAMPLE NOUNS, CONJUGATED

Noun	Singular	Plural
kot (cat)	kocie	kotach
kobieta (woman)	kobiecie	kobietach
dziecko (child)	dziecku	dzieciach
Warszawa (Warsaw)	Warszawie	—

TRIGGERING VERBS

No verbs govern this case directly — it's entirely preposition-driven.
Common combos: mówić o (talk about), myśleć o (think about), marzyć o (dream about), pracować w/na (work in/at).

DROP ANY NOUN IN

Myślę o ____.

I'm thinking about ____.

e.g. *Myślę o tobie.*

Jestem w ____.

I am in/at ____.

e.g. *Jestem w domu.*

Used only when directly calling out to or addressing someone — names, titles, terms of endearment. Not connected to any verb or preposition; it just marks "I'm speaking TO you right now."

TRIGGERING PREPOSITIONS

None — the vocative stands alone, often with an interjection ("ej," "halo," "o").

TRIGGERING VERBS

None — it isn't a verb's object; it's purely a form of address.

NOUN ENDINGS AT A GLANCE

Category	Ending	Example
Masculine (sing.)	-e (+ softening) / -u (soft stems, some names)	bracie!, Piotrze! / Tomku!
Feminine (sing.)	-o / -u (names in -ia) / -i (unchanged)	mamo!, kobieto! / Kasiu! / pani!
Neuter (sing.)	= Nominative (no change)	dziecko!
Plural — ALL genders	= Nominative plural (no change)	dzieci!, studenci!

ADJECTIVE ENDINGS (AGREE WITH THE NOUN)

Category	Ending	Example
All genders & numbers	= Nominative adjective endings (no separate vocative form)	dobry! dobra! dobre!

Agreement in action: **dobry kocie! dobra kobieto! dobre dziecko!**

SAMPLE NOUNS, CONJUGATED

Noun	Singular	Plural
brat (brother)	bracie!	bracia! (= nom.)
mama (mom)	mamo!	—
Piotr (Peter)	Piotrze!	—
pani (madam/Ms.)	pani!	panie! (= nom.)

DROP ANY NOUN IN

Cześć, ____!

Hi, ____!

e.g. Cześć, Piotrze!

____, chodź tutaj!

____, come here!

e.g. Mamo, chodź tutaj!